

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

They just don't see eye to eye.



### Learning Outcome

Express duty, advice, willingness, or intention to do something in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- What do you do if you don't get along with a peer?
- What method do you find to be the most effective? Least effective? Why?

### Can Do Statements

- I can talk about work and dealing with customers.
- I can express strong preference and annoyance.
- I can express advice in the present and in the past.

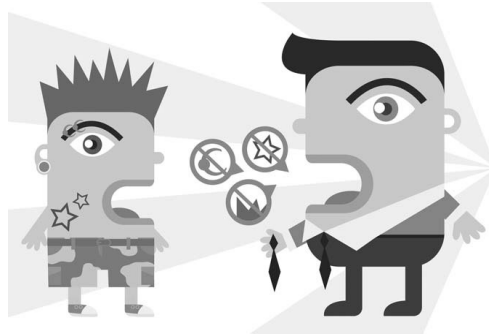




## Let's Explore!

What should be done **to clear the air**\*?

\* To "clear the air" means to get rid of hard feelings.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

Managing can be challenging, especially when it comes to dealing with people whose personalities clash with your own. I would have preferred beforehand to have the knowledge of how to handle employees while keeping personal feelings separate from work. I would rather have focused on tasks and results than my employee's negative personality traits. Managers shouldn't allow their emotions to interfere, and ought to deal with each employee fairly and without favoritism. However, there are often instances in which managers, such as myself, would sooner ignore an employee I like less than the others than interact with them. When managers face employees who refuse to do what's asked of them, they ought to make the best of a potentially unpleasant situation by devising a plan that will diffuse the tension.

As a manager, it's high time I confronted problems head-on. Acknowledging any ill will among staff members can help everyone get back to concentrating on the job that needs to be done.

Seek confirmation. When giving instructions, you shouldn't assume you're making yourself clear. If I were you, I would make sure the employee knows what's expected of them.

Rehearse. You should make your requests simple. When you have something complex to say, don't wing it. You should know what you want to say without jumbling words or backtracking. I would rather explain the goal in as few words as possible.

Speak and write. To ensure that employees understand you, you ought to allocate tasks both orally and in print. I would prefer to get into the habit of speaking directly to an employee to tell them what I expect or need. You ought to let the employee make suggestions or ask questions. After you listen carefully to their response, you should send a follow-up e-mail or memo that reiterates what is expected.

If an employee has an attitude problem, you wouldn't want to allow it to influence or disrupt the job at hand. Instead, you ought to clarify what tasks need attention. The employee would sooner I avoided making any quips about their track record of not complying with my past requests.





## Let's Practice!

Good managers would do it this way!

*Instructions: Read the text below. Circle all phrases that talk about preferences in the present or the future. Read the text aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

I would have preferred to know how to separate emotions from the work at hand when dealing with employees. I would rather have focused on tasks and results rather than my employee's negative personality traits. Managers, such as myself, would sooner turn away from their least favorite employees than interact with them. I would rather use the fewest words possible to describe the goal.



## Let's Practice!

You must put your emotions aside!

*Instructions: Read the dialogue on page 2 again. Answer the following questions.*

1. According to the writer, when dealing with emotions, it is necessary:
  - a) to focus on personal feelings. b) to put aside your feelings. c) to focus on the tension.
2. Having said these things, it is possible that this writer:
  - a) experienced difficulty dealing with their emotions. b) had a manager who treated them badly. c) had a lot of friends.
3. The writer is:
  - a) an employee. b) a manager. c) an owner.
4. When dealing with employees, the writer suggests:
  - a) talking openly about problems. b) harboring ill will. c) quipping about many things. d) backtracking and jumbling words.
5. When dealing with an employee who has an attitude problem, the writer suggests:
  - a) writing an official e-mail. b) writing an e-mail and then a memo. c) having a discussion and then following up with an e-mail. d) having a discussion and then following up with human resources.





## Extension Activity

Write a dialogue between a parent and a teenager.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Watch an episode of the TV show "The World's Strictest Parents" on YouTube. Take notes on any vocabulary you hear and look these words up later.
- Discuss with a classmate what you thought about the teenagers' and parents' behavior and attitudes.
- Write a dialogue between a difficult teenager and a parent using new vocabulary from the episode.
- Read your dialogue in groups.
- Do you think the reality television show was a good idea? Why or why not? Discuss this with classmates.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch a video about strict parents and troublesome teenagers and discuss it with classmates.

☐ ☐

I write a dialogue between a parent and a teenager using relevant vocabulary.

☐ ☐

I practice my dialogue in groups.

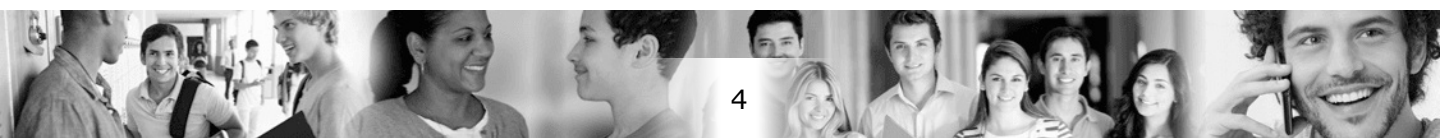
☐ ☐

I share my views on the reality TV show.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- to devise** (verb): to plan or invent a new way of doing something  
e.g. They ought to make the best of a potentially unpleasant situation by devising a plan that will diffuse the tension.
- potentially** (adjective): not relevant now, but may become so in the future  
e.g. Managers should try to make the best of potentially difficult situations.
- ill will** (noun): unfriendly or unkind feelings towards someone  
e.g. Acknowledging any ill will among staff members can help everyone get back to concentrating on the job.
- wing it** (expression): to do something without planning or preparing it  
e.g. When you have something complex to say, don't wing it.
- to backtrack** (verb): to change an opinion or promise that you gave so that it is not as strong as it was earlier  
e.g. You should know what you want to say without backtracking.
- to jumble** (verb): to mix things together without any order  
e.g. Don't jumble the words.
- orally** (adverb): expressed in speech, not writing  
e.g. To ensure that employees understand you, you ought to allocate tasks both orally and in print.
- quip** (noun): a clever remark  
e.g. I avoided making any quips about their track record.





## Learning Points

### Would Rather, Would Sooner, Would Have Preferred

You use **would rather/would sooner** + *Simple Past* or **would have preferred to** + *infinitive* to talk about preferences in the present or the future.

You use **would rather/would sooner** + *Simple Past* to talk about a preference or strong advice in the present or the future. In this case, you can use it to talk about when you want someone else to do something.

**Examples:** *I'd rather you focused on customer service.*

*Vanessa would sooner I stayed in the kitchen.*

You also use **would have preferred to** + *infinitive* to express preference or advice.

**Example:** *I would have preferred to receive higher ratings.*

You can use the expression **It's high time ...** + *Past Simple* to express a preference about the past or the present.

**Example:** *It's high time we changed our menu.*

#### Examples:

- *I would have preferred beforehand to have the knowledge of how to handle employees while keeping personal feelings separate from work.*
- *I would rather have focused on tasks and results than my employee's negative personality traits.*
- *There are often instances in which managers, such as myself, would sooner ignore an employee I like less than the others than interact with them.*
- *As a manager, it's high time I confronted problems head-on.*





## Learning Points

### Modals for Advice

You use modals like **should** or **ought to** to give advice.

You use **would** with an if-clause to give advice and suggestions about a hypothetical situation.

The most common modals for giving advice are: **should**, **ought to** and **would**.

You can think of modals as "helping verbs". They add meaning to the main verb of a sentence. In this case, these modals add the meaning of advice.

**Should** is the most common modal used to give advice.

**Ought to** is used for giving strong advice.

**Would** can be used with an if-clause to give personal advice or suggestion as a hypothetical situation, like *If I were you, I would ...*

Look at the following structures:

| Subject    | Modal                   | Main Verb + Advice                          |
|------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <i>You</i> | <i>should/shouldn't</i> | <b><i>talk</i></b> to the customers nicely. |
| <i>You</i> | <i>ought to</i>         | <b><i>focus</i></b> on the service.         |
| <i>I</i>   | <i>would/wouldn't</i>   | <b><i>speak</i></b> out of turn.            |

### Examples:

- Managers **shouldn't** allow their personal feelings to interfere.
- Managers **ought to** devise a strategy for making the best of a potentially explosive situation.
- **If I were you, I would** make sure the employee knows what's expected of them.
- You **wouldn't** let the person's personality interfere with the job at hand.

